



14 May 1948

JEWISH LEADERS PROCLAIM THE STATE OF ISRAEL

After World War I, the territory of Palestine was declared a mandate of the British Empire. Zionists had been calling for it to be the Jewish homeland since the 1880s, and Jewish immigration increased after World War II. When the British mandate expired, Israeli leaders proclaimed Israel an independent Jewish state, displacing more than 750,000 Palestinians. Five Arab nations invaded, sparking the first Arab-Israeli war.

◀ Jerusalem in the first Arab-Israeli War

30 January 1948
Mahatma Gandhi
is assassinated by a
Hindu nationalist

3 April 1948 US
congress passes the
Marshall Plan to rebuild
European economies

1948

▽ Facsimile of a section of the Dead Sea scrolls



1947

DEAD SEA SCROLLS DISCOVERED

Hidden for centuries in the Judean Desert, the first scrolls were discovered by chance by Bedouin shepherds. Once scholars had realized their importance as some of the earliest known Biblical manuscripts, researchers set out to find and preserve additional texts.



◀ Daniel Malan depicted
on a South African stamp

26 May 1948

DANIEL MALAN'S NATIONALIST PARTY WINS POWER IN SOUTH AFRICA

Taking its support from South Africa's Afrikaner community of white settlers, the National Party

adopted racial segregation – apartheid – as its signature policy. Interracial marriage was banned, and non-whites, who were already denied voting rights, were now also forbidden to enter white-only areas without passes permitting them to do so.